



Supernovas may produce metals

Souped-up supernovas may produce much of the universe's heavy elements.
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Stars may forge universe's gold

Dying stars called collapsars may forge much of the universe's gold.
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Bang & Olufsen Beolit 20

Sublime design and great sound

Bang & Olufsen has always stood out from the crowd in the audio segment due to its impeccable focus on design and performance. The Bang & Olufsen Beolit 20 is the latest variant of the brand's portable speaker series. Let's delve into the full review of the B&O Beolit 20 to find out if it is worth your hard-earned money.



Price
₹45,000

BUILD AND DESIGN

The Bang & Olufsen Beolit 20 is a premium speaker available in two elegant colour variants – Grey Mist and Black Anthracite. We received the former for review and were extremely pleased with its grey and gold colour palette. The company has utilised premium materials to construct the speaker including anodised aluminium, polymer, and vegetable-tanned leather.

The speaker measures 5.3 x 9.1 x 7.5 inches (HWD) and weighs a whopping 2.7kgs. When you think of portable speakers, you don't really imagine lugging around an almost 3kg speaker. It is definitely on the heavier side when it comes to portable speakers, but we wouldn't imagine anyone wanting to bring this exorbitant speaker to too many places. Additionally, the speaker doesn't come with an IP rating, which is why we would advise users against bringing this speaker with you on trips, or outdoor events.

The mid-section of the speaker has a wraparound aluminium grille, behind which you have a 5.5-inch woofer, three 1.5-inch full-range drivers and two 4-inch passive bass radiators. The speaker is powered by the slightly dated Bluetooth v4.2 and supports SBC and AAC codecs, but there's no aptX support, unfortunately.

The top portion of the speaker is slightly recessed, like a tray and houses



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the controls. The tray is also a Qi wireless charger, so you can simply plonk down your compatible devices in the centre of the 'tray' to wirelessly charge them.

FEATURES

The most interesting feature of the B&O Beolit 20 is one we've already touched upon in the previous section – Qi wireless charging. The device can power any Qi wireless charging compatible device. It isn't fast charging, by any means, but it is useful when needed in a pinch.

The speaker comes with a company-rated battery life of 8 hours over the 6 hours of its predecessor, which is a pretty decent jump. In our tests, the speaker was able to power through a little lower than 6 hours of playtime at around 60 per cent volume.

The speaker can also connect to the Bang & Olufsen app for iOS and Android that gives users access to many more features such as track playback, track navigation, EQ presents, and even a custom EQ.

Now, while these seem like a decent set of features, the speaker is slightly lacking feature-wise for this price. You only get Bluetooth v4.2 connectivity, no IP rating, and no Wi-Fi support. Additionally, there are no smart features on the device, and you cannot even connect to your voice assistant, which is a shame since it puts a cap on its abilities.

PERFORMANCE

The Beolit 20 comes with powerful and impressive sound quality. It delivers solid low-frequency thump and doesn't distort at high volumes as well. The vocals have a smooth, musical quality to them with good clarity and dynamism for the most part. However, there is slight sibilance in the vocals at times. In vocal-centric tracks such as Hello by Adele, her voice soars beautifully and never gets veiled in the mix. Even bass-heavy tracks reproduce vocals well without veiling their details. Overall, you get full-bodied lows, rich vocals, and detailed highs that make most tracks sound great. The speaker doesn't have a flat response, but it definitely delivers a rich experience.

This speaker is also really loud, which is what you'd expect when you look at its size. It can easily fill large rooms with its sound, and can even work well outdoors. The soundstage is decently wide but the separation is pretty good, for the most part. If you enjoy speakers with a rich, warm sound profile, the Beolit 20 has exactly that, done to near perfection.

VERDICT

If design and performance are of utmost importance to you, the Bang & Olufsen Beolit 20 portable speaker is an excellent option with great sound, good battery life, and Qi wireless charging support. However, if connectivity options such as Wi-Fi and smart features such as voice assistant support is important to you, it's best to look away since you won't find them here.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

SPEAKER CONFIGURATION: 3 x 1.5" Full Range, 1 x 5.5" Long-Stroke Wideband Woofer, 2 x 4" Passive Bass Radiators | **AMPLIFIER:** 2 x 35W Class D for Woofer And Tweeter | **FREQUENCY RANGE:** 37 - 20,000 Hz | **MAXIMUM SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL @1M:** 93dB SPL | **WIRELESS CODEC:** AAC, SBC | **WEIGHT:** 2700 g | **DIMENSIONS:** 135 W x 230 H x 189 D mm | **BATTERY PLAYTIME:** Up to 8 hours at typical listening volumes | **BATTERY SIZE:** 3,200 mAh

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